

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A world map with a light blue background. Dashed blue lines radiate from India, connecting it to various countries across the globe, including the United States, Canada, Mexico, Central American countries, Caribbean Sea, Venezuela, South American countries, Africa, Europe, Middle East, Asia, and Oceania. The map also shows major oceans and seas.

INDIA'S NEW FRIENDS

MODULE - 8

INDO-SOVIET RELATIONS

1 Rajiv Gandhi's first foreign state visit was to the Soviet Union.

2 This was to achieve several objectives

- Strengthening the Bilateral relationship
- Military procurements and assistance in civil nuclear technology
- Focus on areas of Mutual cooperation
- USSR support to India on political, diplomatic and strategic issues
- Attempting to contain the threat of nuclear weapons.



RAJIV'S APPROACH TOWARDS WEST INDO-US RELATIONS

PM Rajiv Gandhi, attempted to reduce hostilities between India and US.

- 1 He visited US in 1985 to jointly develop new technologies in agriculture, medicine and energy.
- 2 During the visit, PM Rajiv Gandhi opposed the Strategic Defence Initiative (SDI), or the Star Wars scheme which proposed the introduction of weapons in space, capable of deflecting a nuclear attack.
- 3 According to Prime Minister, it was an unwarranted militarisation of space

- 4 Simultaneously, he declined the invitation of USSR for installations in Serbia.



RAJIV'S APPROACH TOWARDS WEST

INDO-US RELATIONS

- 5 India's image in US was increasingly improving.
- 6 India was a stable democracy and was perceived as a major power because of its growing economic, military and commercial strength, agriculture programs and American business interests.
- 7 Indo-US relations helped India in its socio-economic development.
- 8 Indo-US relations also led to modernization in telecommunication sector, reforms in education, science & technology.
- 9 PM Rajiv Gandhi introduced computer in consultation with Sam Pitroda.



STRATEGIC COMPULSIONS- DEVIATION FROM NAM- VIOLATION OF INDO-SOVIET TREATY

OR

NEW STEPS TOWARDS INDIA'S DEVELOPMENT

- 1 In Rajiv Gandhi's India, Indo-US relations gained strength.
- 2 It was viewed as an instrument for bringing peace and stability in South Asia
- 3 Moreover, anti-US perceptions were growing in Pakistan, its pawn in South Asia.



INDO-ISRAEL RELATIONS

1 The beginning of the peace process in Middle East along with the collapse of Soviet Union paved the way for developing relations with Israel.

2 With US, the only superpower in the world 1989, India established ties with Israel

3 The relations covered several areas including military. It did not affect India's national and geopolitical interest.

4 India has traditionally supported the Arabs and the Palestinians against Israel in UN. This changed in 1985.

5 After the 1985 Israeli bombing of Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) headquarters in Tunis, 18 Arab states sponsored a UN General Assembly resolution calling for the expulsion of Israel from the UN. India abstained from voting on the resolution



RENEWED RELATIONS

- At the 40th UNGA session, PM Rajiv Gandhi met the Israeli PM Peres.
- Visa restrictions for Israeli citizens was also relaxed.
- India also allowed the Israeli tennis team to play at the Davis Cup Tournament in 1987.



CHALLENGES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

- In spite of these initiatives, Indo-Israel relations were not completely revived.
- In November 1988, India became one of the first non-Arab countries to recognise the new state of Palestine.
- Domestic political and electoral constraints and regional developments restricted deeper relations with Israel



NEIGHBORHOOD POLICY AND MARITIME SECURITY

RAJIV GANDHI ON INDIAN OCEAN

- 1 Rajiv Gandhi understood the importance of Indian Ocean and the strategic importance of India's Union Territories in the Ocean.
- 2 Lakshadweep's lagoons on the Indian Ocean as a part of exclusive economic zone acquired importance in India's domestic and foreign policy.
- 3 PM Rajiv Gandhi approached the development of these island distinctly.
- 4 An Island Development Authority (IDA) was set up within the Planning Commission headed by the environmentalist M G K Menon.



DEVELOPMENT IN THE NEIGHBORHOOD

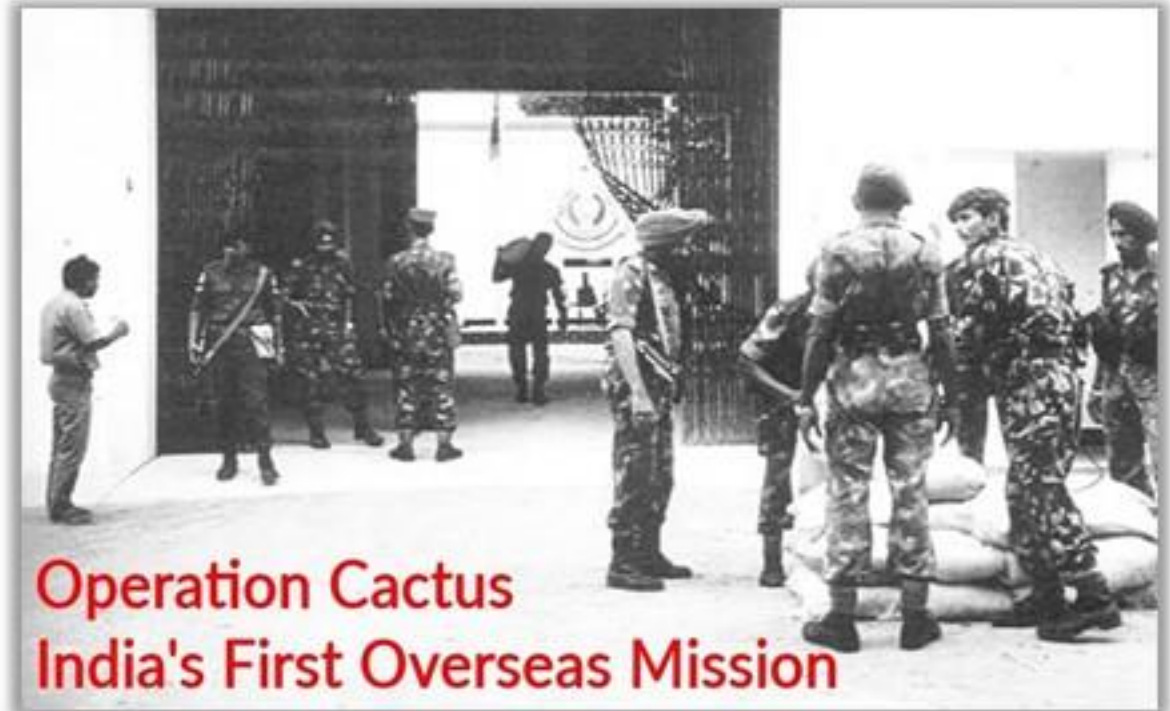
INDO-MALDIVES RELATIONS

- 1** In November 1988, Sri Lankan militants from the People's Liberation Organisation of Tamil Eelam (PLOTE), backed by Maldivian businessman, mounted a coup in the Maldives.
- 2** President Gayoom asked for help from a number of nations including India, Pakistan, the United States, Britain, Malaysia, Sri Lanka and other states.
- 3** Sri Lanka and Malaysia took time to reach Maldives by sea.
- 4** The US and Britain, decided they wouldn't intervene directly, but coordinate a response with India.



INDIA'S RESPONSE

- 1 According to Rajiv Gandhi, the neighborhood was India's zone of influence.
- 2 India was the largest country in the region had to bear the fallout of conflicts and unrest within its smaller neighboring countries, like had happened in East Pakistan
- 3 Thus, India responded with an overwhelming speed and efficiency.



Operation Cactus
India's First Overseas Mission

OPERATION CACTUS

- 1 The militants in Maldives had not touched the Hulhule airport. This was utilized by India and the Indian air force landed on the Hulhule and took control over the airport.
- 2 They then reached the capital using commandeered boats and rescued President Gayoom, driving out the militants.
- 3 A small vessel with a group of mercenaries, and carrying hostages, managed an escape while the Indian troops advanced and took back the capital.
- 4 The INS Godavari and INS Betwa of the Indian Navy were used in the operation



OPERATION CACTUS WAS SUCCESSFUL

- 1 Operation Cactus was testimony to the fact that India could play a role in ensuring security in Asia.
- 2 India's swift and decisive action was acknowledged by the international community.
- 3 India's then-Cabinet Secretary said Operation Cactus enhanced India's prestige enormously and showed our efficiency and capability to mount a successful operation at short notice.



RAJIV GANDHI ON CHINA

- 1 In 1986, there was a standoff between the Indian and the Chinese armies at Sumdorongchu .
- 2 Sumdorongchu valley is located east of tri-junction with Bhutan and not far from Doklam.
- 3 According to Indian reports, Chinese army occupied an Indian patrol point.
- 4 In February 1987, Arunachal Pradesh became a full-fledged state of India.



PM RAJIV GANDHI VISITS CHINA

- 1 The visit by the Indian PM to China strengthened bilateral relations.
- 2 Both the sides agreed to negotiate a boundary settlement and maintain peace and tranquillity at the boundary.
- 3 At the meeting, China appreciated India's stand of not interfering in China's domestic affairs
- 4 It also appreciated that India considered Tibet to be an integral part of China and it would not allow Tibetan separatist activities on Indian soil.

- 5 China's Deng Xiaoping hoped that both countries would look forward to the 'future and not unpleasant past'.



RESULTS OF THE VISIT (ACCORDING TO MEA)

1 India and China acknowledged the progress made in bilateral cooperation.

2 They noted that exchanges in trade, culture, science and technology, aviation and other fields were enhanced in recent years

3 The two sides emphasized that the Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence jointly initiated by China and India were the fundamental principles guiding state to state relations and the establishment of a new international political order and economic order.

4 During the visit, the two governments signed an agreement on cooperation in science and technology, an agreement on civil aviation transportation and plans to implement the bilateral cultural agreements for 1988 to 1990.



SAARC SUMMIT

Need for South Asian Association

- 1 The first SAARC summit was held during prime ministership of Rajiv Gandhi at Dhaka in 1985.
- 2 It was an important attempt to further regional cooperation and promote welfare of people of in South Asia.
- 3 The South Asian cooperation saw participation of Bangladesh, Bhutan, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka.



ATTENTION TO NEIGHBOURS AND SOUTH ASIA

SAARC

- 1 At the Summit, the Member States expressed concern at the arms race and overall deteriorating international political situation.
- 2 They emphasized on the need to abide by the principles of UN charter.
- 3 The member states encouraged the Nuclear Weapon states to undertake negotiations on CTBT, thus ending testing, production, and deployment of nuclear weapons



INDIA-AUSTRALIA

1 In the light of these changing stances in India foreign policy, PM Rajiv Gandhi's visit to Australia in 1986 becomes important.

2 Australia is important to address its energy needs. India had a growing population, and with its expanding demands and greater economic development, its energy requirements were increasing.

3 India was dependent on Australian coal and iron ore. Perceiving at a future requirement for uranium, importance of Australia in India's foreign policy would increase further.

The countries conducted naval exercises as a part of its strategic relations (maritime security)

4 Australia was an important as a destination for students and emigrants, particularly from Punjab, Gujarat.

5 Cricket diplomacy was prominent in Indo-Australian relations.



INDIA'S MISSILE PROGRAM

- 1 In March 1988, under PM Rajiv Gandhi India tested its first surface-to-surface missile, Prithvi ballistic missile, capable of attacking targets up to a distance of a hundred miles away.
- 2 Indian missile scientists had taken their country into an exclusive club whose only other members were the United States, the Soviet Union, the United Kingdom, France, China and Israel.

These developments attracted apprehension in the smaller countries of South Asia.



INDO-SRI LANKAN RELATIONS

1 India sent the Indian Peacekeeping Force to Sri Lanka to resolve the ethnic problem between local Sinhalese and Tamilians in country. This decision was consistent with India's growing perception of itself as the 'rightful regional hegemon in South Asia'.

2 The Rajiv Gandhi – Jayewardene Accord addressed the three contentious issues between India and Sri Lanka:

- Indo-Sri Lankan strategic interests
- Issue concerning people of Indian origin in Sri Lanka
- Question of Tamil minority rights in Sri Lanka.



INDO-SRI LANKAN RELATIONS

- 3 The Accord sent a strong message to its neighbors, to the global powers and delineated India's strategic zone of influence in the Indian Ocean region.
- 4 Rajiv Gandhi managed to thwart the Chinese entry into the Indian Ocean.
- 5 The Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) however, felt betrayed by this decision and Rajiv Gandhi was assassinated in 1991 by a member of LTTE.



VP SINGH GOVERNMENT (1989-90)

ON SRI LANKA

- VP Singh government decided to withdraw the IPKF on the argument that Sri Lanka wanted to withdraw, so India had to oblige.
- The decision disregarded India's desire to place its foot print in the Indian ocean region and its effect on the Army.



ON PAKISTAN

- The weakness of the VP Singh government was used by Pakistan to increase militancy and terrorist activity in Kashmir. Pakistan was preparing for a full-fledged war.
- In response, as a part of the treaty with China, troops were reduced on India's eastern border and deployed on the border with Pakistan. This deterred Pakistan from launching a full-scale war.



DISINTEGRATION OF USSR

1

In 1989, the Berlin Wall, which marked the division of the world into First World and Second World was torn down by the people. It symbolized the disintegration of USSR and the end of Cold war.



DISINTEGRATION OF USSR

2

Its consequences were

- The Cold War came to an end.
- The state-controlled Russian economy collapsed and many underwent major restructuring.
- Capitalist system and Liberal democracy emerged victorious and undisputed leading to a Unipolar world led by USA.
- Importance of institutions like World Bank and IMF increased.
- Disintegration of USSR led to rise of independent nations. Some of these nations joined NATO, some transited into democratic capitalist system through the 'Shock Therapy'.
- Civil war and military conflicts took place in the former Soviet countries like Tajikistan, Azerbaijan; leading to instability in Central Asia
- India and Russia, continued to remain close friends and Russia's geopolitical importance for India is immense.

GULF WAR AND US HEGEMONY

1 The end of the Cold War made the world unipolar. US became more assertive and aggressive. One such instance is the First Gulf War.

2 In August 1990, Iraq invaded Kuwait and occupied it to capture its oil reserves. In response, UN had permitted the liberation of Kuwait by force. This UN operation led by the US force was called 'Operation Desert Storm'.

3 This led to the First Gulf War when troops from 34 countries fought against Iraq and defeated it.

4 On 28 February, 1991, through Operation Desert Sabre, ceasefire was declared by USA and Kuwait was freed.



INDIA'S RESPONSE UNDER PM CHANDRA SHEKHAR

- 1 South Asia in general and India in particular was affected by the Gulf crisis as they were dependent on the Middle East for supply of oil.
- 2 India was dependent on Iraq and Kuwait for 40 percent of its oil imports.
- 3 There was also loss of remittances by their nationals working in Middle East. In addition, they had to incur costs for their repatriation.



The Real Airlift

INDIA'S RESPONSE UNDER PM CHANDRA SHEKHAR

- 4 Between August 13 and October 20 of 1990, India evacuated over 1,75,000 of its nationals from Kuwait, the biggest such operation by the Indian government.
- 5 India could not explicitly oppose Iraq because it was Muslim dominated and it supported India on Kashmir issue.
- 6 India under PM Chandra Shekhar initially stayed non-aligned. But India rejected Iraq's demand that the issue be linked to the Palestinian conflict.



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